

Qianwen (Kaia) Gao

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SUMMARY

UC Berkeley Computational Social Science master's graduate working across product analytics, user research, and AI evaluation. Co-author of CHASE (accepted to COLM 2026) and builder of PickMem.

EDUCATION

University of California, Berkeley Jun 2025 - May 2026

Master of Computational Social Science | GPA: 3.87/4.00

Zhejiang University

Sep 2021 - Jun 2025

Bachelor of Arts, Communication | GPA: 3.95/4.00

SKILLS

Languages & development: Python, SQL, R, TypeScript, React, Next.js, Node.js, PostgreSQL

Research & analytics: A/B testing, causal inference, regression, survey design, behavioral analysis

AI & data: LLM evaluation, RAG, NLP, scikit-learn, pandas, Tableau, Streamlit

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Wroodium | *AI Research Intern* Dec 2025 - Jul 2026

- **AI Evaluation Research** - Co-authored CHASE, investigating how repeated optimization for LLM rankings reshapes content ecosystems across six domains; paper accepted to COLM 2026.
- **Causal Benchmark Development** - Led FreshRAG benchmark development to study content freshness and RAG hallucination; built temporal QA data using Myers diff and designed factorial experiments with regression-based analysis.

APPA Health | *Strategy & Data Analyst Intern* Sep - Dec 2025

- **Impact Measurement** - Established a KPI framework for youth wellness programs and analyzed pre/post survey data to assess student engagement and inform program iteration and funding reports.

RedNote | *Marketing Analytics Intern* Aug 2024 - Jan 2025

- **Audience Segmentation** - Analyzed behavioral and demographic data with SQL in Hive to build 35 audience segments for pet-industry advertisers, contributing to CNY 1.83M in ad revenue.
- **Experimentation & Reporting** - Automated KPI dashboards with Python, SQL, and RedBI; designed A/B tests for targeting and creatives and presented performance insights to 740+ clients and internal stakeholders.

Didi | *Product & User Analytics Intern* Mar - Jun 2024

- **Pricing Analytics** - Applied regression and causal inference to supply, demand, and price elasticity, informing pricing strategies that contributed to a 2% revenue lift.
- **User Research** - Designed user surveys and combined findings with behavioral data analysis to identify hourly-driver service pain points, informing improvements that reduced complaints by 3%.

PUBLICATION

CHASE: How Content Ecosystems Are Reshaped When Ranking Is the Only Target

Qianwen Gao, Zichang Su, Yiwen Hou, Arlen Kumar, Leanid Palkhouski.

Accepted to the Conference on Language Modeling (**COLM 2026**). arXiv:2608.30466

PROJECTS

PickMem | *Personal Project* Jul 2026

- Built an LLM memory-curation application for capturing, organizing, and retrieving information with semantic search; implemented a full-stack application using React, TypeScript, Node.js, Express, and MongoDB.
- Built secure authentication, backend APIs, and optimized database queries to support fast semantic retrieval through a responsive user interface.

Student Absenteeism Analysis | *ONGB & Wizearly* Feb - May 2026

- Integrated national datasets with OUSD student records to develop predictive features and early-warning analyses; created a landscape report and interactive dashboard to support education intervention planning.

LEADERSHIP

ZJU Lingyun Musical Club | *President* Sep 2021 - May 2024

- Led 150+ members across eight departments and delivered an annual musical production attended by 6,000+ people.